

WOOP Helps You Stay Focused

WOOP is an effective mental contrasting exercise used to help develop self-control so that you can achieve what matters most to you.

Achieve Your Goals Using WOOP

This goal setting framework can be used to help you stay focused on reaching your goals using a simple four step plan: first envisioning your goal, then imagining how it feels to achieve it, next identifying what might get in the way of achieving this goal, and finally planning in advance how you will take action to overcome any obstacle by creating an if/then statement to help you stay focused on achieving your goal.

W ish What would you like to accomplish? A wish is something that gets you excited, is challenging but you know is realistic.	My wish:
O utcome Your best outcome would be achieving your goal. How would achieving your goal make you feel? Imagine this outcome.	Best outcome:
O bstacle Personal obstacles can derail you from achieving your goal. Imagine what obstacle might stand in your way.	My obstacle:
P lan Identify the action you can take to overcome your obstacle. Write an "if/then" statement to plan how you will accomplish your goal and imagine yourself achieving it.	If: (my obstacle) Then I will: (my action)

Reference

Oettingen, G., Mayer, D., Sevincer, A. T., Stephens, E. J., Pak, H., & Hagenah, M. (2009). Mental contrasting and goal commitment: The mediating role of energization. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*, 35, 608–622.